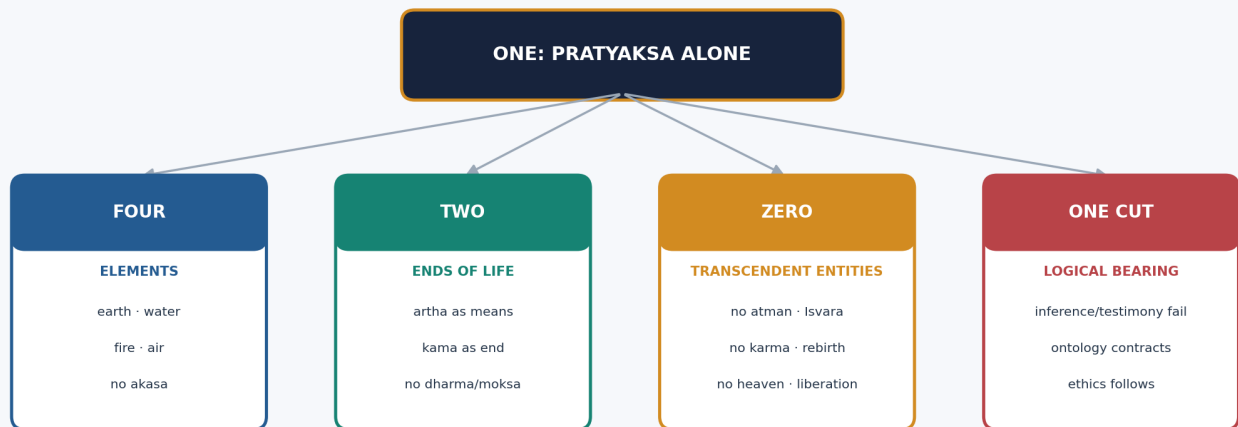


Cārvāka / Lokāyata — Learner-First V2 Pilot

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

CARVAKA: ONTOLOGY AS THE SHADOW OF EPISTEMOLOGY

Only perception is a truth-guaranteeing pramana



ONE pramana · FOUR elements · TWO purusharthas · ZERO transcendent entities

Exam logic: derive each denial from the epistemic restriction; do not present a disconnected list.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Cārvāka / Lokāyata — Learner-First V2 Complete Learning Session	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
Part II — 32 Hard UPSC-Style MCQs	3
Part III — Remedial MCQs: Category Errors and Textual-Source Uncertainty	15
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	18
Legacy subtopic exam-application routes	18
1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem — exam application	18
2. Epistemology — Perception as the Sole Pramāṇa — exam application	18
3. The Critique of Inference — Vyāpti, Upādhi, the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation — exam application	19
4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference — and a Critically Balanced Verdict — exam application	19
5. Metaphysics and Materialism — Four Bhūtas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Svabhāvavāda — exam application	20
6. Self, Body and Consciousness — Dehātmanvāda, and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks) — exam application	20
7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities — God, Soul, Karma, Rebirth, Heaven, Mokṣa, Veda and Ritual — exam application	22
8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning — and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks) — exam application	22
9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture — exam application	23
Part I — All 9 Verified Topic-Owned PYQs (2018–2025)	25
Part IV — Ten Original Solved Mains Questions	37
Part V — Philosophy Optional High-Score Answer Protocol (Cārvāka)	45

Cārvāka / Lokāyata — Learner-First V2 Complete Learning Session

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic only — not Prelims PYQs. Philosophy Optional is Mains-only. These objective checks are retrieval and misconception diagnostics. The correct options rotate strictly **A -> B -> C -> D**, continuously across the 32 mastery questions and 10 remedial questions.

Part II — 32 Hard UPSC-Style MCQs

Key discipline: Questions 1–32 follow the correct-answer sequence **A, B, C, D** repeated exactly **eight times**, with no deviation. Each question has four plausible options, a detailed explanation, and a one-line trap note. Coverage spans all nine subtopics of the learning session.

MCQ 1 — The three names

Which set correctly pairs each name of the school with the sense recorded in the standard textbooks?

- A. *Cārvāka* — from *carv*, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from *cāru-vāk*, "sweet-worded"; *Lokāyata* — *lokāyata-mata*, "the view of the common people"; *Bārhaspatya* — "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose *Sūtra* is lost.
- B. *Cārvāka* — "the four-element theorist"; *Lokāyata* — "the world-renouncer"; *Bārhaspatya* — a disciple of Jayarāśi.
- C. *Cārvāka* — a Buddhist sect of the *Majjhima Nikāya*; *Lokāyata* — the Jaina name for materialism; *Bārhaspatya* — a Mīmāṃsā sub-school.
- D. *Cārvāka* — "the sceptic"; *Lokāyata* — "the ritualist"; *Bārhaspatya* — the author of the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta record both etymologies of "*Cārvāka*" — the name of a sage, or a descriptive name from *carv* ("eat, chew") or *cāru-vāk* ("nice word") — and gloss *lokāyatamata* as "the view of common people". Sharma records Bṛhaspati as "a heretical teacher ... regarded as the traditional founder of this school", whose *Sūtra* "has unfortunately perished". D misattributes the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*, which is Jayarāśi's.

MEMORY: Trap: *Lokāyata* means "of the common people", not "world-renouncing" — the school is emphatically **this-worldly**.

MCQ 2 — The exact sense of *nāstika*

In Sanskrit philosophical literature, in what sense or senses is *Cārvāka nāstika*?

- A. Only in the modern vernacular sense of "atheist", since it denies God.
- B. In **both** classical senses — it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are *nāstika* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second.
- C. In neither sense, since *nāstika* applies only to schools that deny the external world.
- D. Only in the second sense, since *Cārvāka* accepts Vedic authority while rejecting the afterlife.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set this out exactly: "'Āstika' means 'one who believes in the authority of the Vedas' or 'one who believes in life after death'... The six orthodox schools are 'āstika', and the *Cārvāka* is '*nāstika*' in **both the senses**." They add that in the second sense "even the Jaina and Bauddha schools are '*āstika*', as they believe in life after death." A adopts the modern vernacular sense, which fails because Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet *āstika*. D reverses the school's most famous rejection.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *nāstika* is primarily about **Vedic authority**, not about God.

MCQ 3 — The source situation

Which statement best describes the textual situation of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. The complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives with three commentaries.
- B. Nothing whatever is known of the school, since all sources are hostile.
- C. No systematic primary work survives; the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and only about a dozen *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views **in order to refute them**, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".
- D. The *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is an independent primary source written by a Cārvāka.

Answer: C

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism... almost every work of the other schools states, **for refutation**, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma adds that even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", which disposes of D. B overstates: convergence across independent hostile sources still fixes a doctrinal core.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is Mādhava's Vedāntic compendium — an opponent's summary, not Cārvāka scripture.

MCQ 4 — Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

What is the correct scholarly use of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa's *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* in a Cārvāka answer?

- A. As the primary text establishing that perception alone is a *pramāṇa*.
- B. As a Nyāya refutation of Cārvāka epistemology.
- C. As a Mīmāṃsā defence of Vedic authority against the materialists.
- D. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition **and** as its internal limit-case — since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of **perceptual** knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta describe the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* as "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism" whose author "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements", concluding "like an anti-intellectualist pragmatist" that practical life goes on regardless. Sharma records its publication by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940. A is exactly the misuse the option is designed to test; B and C misplace him entirely.

MEMORY: **Trap:** using Jayarāśi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis — perception alone is a *pramāṇa* — that defines the school.

MCQ 5 — The pramāṇa ledger

Arranged by the number of independent *pramāṇas* admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.
- B. Cārvāka 2 · Nyāya 3 · Mīmāṃsā 4 · Advaita 5.
- C. Cārvāka 1 · Nyāya 2 · Sāṃkhya 4 · Advaita 3.
- D. All schools admit exactly three *pramāṇas*, differing only in their names.

Answer: A

Explanation: This is the standard ledger of classical Indian epistemology: Cārvāka admits perception alone; Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism add inference; Sāṃkhya-Yoga add testimony; Nyāya adds comparison; Prābhākara adds postulation; Bhāṭṭa and Advaita add non-apprehension. Cārvāka sits at the **lower bound**, which is precisely why every other school must justify its additions against him. B, C and D misplace multiple schools.

MEMORY: **Trap:** Cārvāka is not an eccentric outlier but the minimum of a shared ledger — say so, and the answer immediately looks structural rather than descriptive.

MCQ 6 — Internal perception and consciousness

An opponent argues: "Internal perception gives immediate knowledge of our mental states, and in these we perceive consciousness, which is nowhere found in external material objects; so there must be an immaterial substance whose quality consciousness is." How does the Cārvāka respond?

- A. He denies that consciousness exists.
- B. He **admits** that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity — consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.
- C. He denies internal perception altogether, admitting only the five external senses.
- D. He accepts the argument and admits an immaterial soul while denying its immortality.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the reply verbatim in substance: "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity. As consciousness is perceived to exist in the perceptible living body composed of the material elements, it must be a quality of this body itself." A makes him an eliminativist; C would gut the very reply he needs; D contradicts *dehātmavāda*.

MEMORY: **Trap:** Cārvāka is a **materialist** about consciousness, not a **denier** of it.

MCQ 7 — Truth as an "accident"

The Cārvāka concedes that people constantly act on inference and that inferences sometimes succeed. What philosophical conclusion does he draw from that concession?

- A. That inference is therefore a *pramāṇa* in practical matters.
- B. That success proves the underlying *vyāpti*.
- C. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" — so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that *pramāṇa*-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.
- D. That all inferences are false.

Answer: C

Explanation: The formulation is Chatterjee and Datta's: people "act uncritically on the wrong belief that our inference is true"; sometimes inference succeeds and sometimes it errs; therefore truth is "only an accident, and a separable one, that we find only in some inferences." A and B are the very inferences the Cārvāka blocks. D overstates: he never claims all inferences are false, only that truth does not belong to inference **as such**.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the argument is about the **modality** of truth's attachment to inference — accidental and separable, not essential and inseparable.

MCQ 8 — The rejection of śabda

Which reconstruction correctly gives the Cārvāka argument against testimony as an independent *pramāṇa*?

- A. Words are unreal, therefore what they express is unreal.

- B. Only *ṛṣis* are reliable, and no *ṛṣi* is now perceivable.
- C. Scripture is composed by human beings, therefore every scriptural statement is false.
- D. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" — so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Answer: D

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's argument step for step, and it explains why the Cārvāka can reject *śabda* as a *pramāṇa* without rejecting language: sounds are perceived, meanings are not. A is false — words are perceived and real. B invents a condition of reliability the Cārvāka never accepts. C is a non sequitur; the Cārvāka's charge against the Veda is epistemic and sociological, not a general inference from human authorship to falsity.

MEMORY: Trap: rejecting testimony as a *pramāṇa* is not rejecting communication.

MCQ 9 — Door 1

Why, according to the Cārvāka, can *vyāpti* not be established by perception?

- A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of **all** cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".
- B. Because perception is itself invalid, being contradicted by inference in cases such as the apparently flat earth.
- C. Because perception apprehends only universals and never the particulars between which the relation is supposed to hold.
- D. Because *vyāpti* is a relation between words rather than between things, and words are not perceived.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta state the argument in exactly these terms: the major premise "can be established only if we have a knowledge of all cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible." B is Sharma's counter-attack against the Cārvāka, not the Cārvāka's own reasoning — he accepts perception as the one *pramāṇa*. C inverts the position, and would in any case describe Nyāya's *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* doctrine rather than Cārvāka's. D confuses the semantic vehicle of the universal with its content; the Cārvāka's objection is evidential, and he elsewhere insists that words heard **are** perceived.

MEMORY: Trap: the gap between the observed set and the universal claimed is a gap of **kind**, not of degree — no amount of further counting closes it.

MCQ 10 — The class-character reply

An objector says: granted we cannot perceive all individual smokes, we can perceive the class-characters "smokeness" and "fireness" and the relation between them, and so license the inference. What is the Cārvāka's two-part reply?

- A. That class-characters are perceived only by *yogins*.
- B. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between **all individual** cases follows — to infer a **particular** fire one must know it is inseparably related to the **particular** smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."
- C. That class-characters do not exist, since only Nyāya posits universals.
- D. That the relation between class-characters is established by testimony.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give both limbs: the universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference, and the class-character is itself not perceptually knowable while all instances are not

perceived. A invents a doctrine of yogic perception the Cārvāka would reject outright. C states a stronger ontological thesis than the reply requires. D contradicts the rejection of *śabda*.

MEMORY: **Trap**: the reply is **two-part**; giving only one limb halves the argument.

MCQ 11 — Door 2 and the deduction–induction pair

Sharma summarises the Cārvāka case against inference with the line "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle." What exactly does each half assert?

- A. That induction is deductive and deduction is inductive.
- B. That both are valid but useless.
- C. That **deduction** is a *petitio principii*, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and **induction**, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" — so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.
- D. That deduction is invalid in form and induction is invalid in matter.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sharma states both halves in these terms, adding the Cārvāka gibe that "the logicians ... find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference." D is wrong on the first half: the Cārvāka concedes deductive **validity** and attacks the grounding of the premise. A is incoherent; B misses the epistemic point.

MEMORY: **Trap**: the dilemma is a trap because each horn's cure is the other horn's wound.

MCQ 12 — Door 3's second bolt

Besides the circularity of grounding inference in testimony whose own validity is inferred, what **second** objection does the Cārvāka raise against basing *vyāpti* on testimony?

- A. That testimony is always given in Sanskrit, which most people do not understand.
- B. That testimony belongs to the *āstika* schools alone.
- C. That testimony is a species of perception and therefore adds nothing.
- D. That "if inference always depended on testimony, **no one could infer anything by himself**" — which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma both record this reductio. It is independent of the circularity objection and is regularly omitted by candidates, which is exactly why it is worth carrying. A is irrelevant; B is false of Jainism and Buddhism, which reject Vedic authority but use testimony; C confuses the perception of **sounds** with the acceptance of **content**.

MEMORY: **Trap**: two bolts on Door 3 — circularity **and** the first-person point.

MCQ 13 — The upādhi example

In the standard textbook illustration of *upādhi*, which inference goes wrong, and why?

- A. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives **fire** and infers **smoke**; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (*upādhi*) of **wetness of fuel**, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.
- B. A man perceives smoke and infers fire; he errs because smoke may arise without fire.
- C. A man perceives a rope and infers a snake; he errs because of defective light.
- D. A man perceives a *gavaya* and infers a cow; he errs because similarity is not identity.

Answer: A

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's example verbatim in substance, and note the **direction**: the defective inference runs from fire to smoke, not from smoke to fire. Sharma and the authored knowledge file confirm the same case. B reverses the direction and states a claim the Cārvāka does not make in this illustration; C is the standard Advaita example of error; D concerns *upamāna*.

MEMORY: **Trap:** candidates routinely reverse this example. The *upādhi* case is **fire → smoke**, defeated by wet fuel; a red-hot iron ball is fire without smoke.

MCQ 14 — The causal escape

A logician proposes: "We can ground the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a **causal** relation between them." How does the Cārvāka answer?

- A. That causal relations are established by scripture.
- B. That "a causal relation, being **only a kind of invariable relation**, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" — so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived *upādhi* is operating.
- C. That causation is a category of the understanding imposed by the mind.
- D. That causal relations hold only between material elements and therefore cannot ground any inference.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give exactly this reply, and add the crucial second step about *upādhi*: mere repeated co-occurrence proves nothing until unconditionality is secured, and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden". A contradicts the rejection of *śabda*; C imports Kant; D is not the Cārvāka's argument.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the causal move is not an escape — a causal relation is a **species** of the invariable relation under attack.

MCQ 15 — The Socrates syllogism

According to the Cārvāka, what precisely is wrong with "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal"?

- A. The middle term is undistributed, making the syllogism formally invalid.
- B. Socrates is not perceived by the speaker, so no proposition about him can be entertained.
- C. Nothing in its **form** — but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as *vyāpti*, and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii* or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.
- D. The conclusion concerns a future event, and no statement about the future can be meaningful.

Answer: C

Explanation: The Cārvāka grants formal validity and attacks the grounding of the universal; Sharma adds that the conclusion is "already contained in the major premise". A misdescribes a valid Barbara syllogism. B would abolish reference through testimony altogether, which even the Cārvāka does not do, since words are perceived. D imports a verificationist thesis about future-tensed statements that no Cārvāka source advances in this form.

MEMORY: **Trap:** never write that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism **invalid**.

MCQ 16 — The self-refutation charge

Which formulation states the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka most precisely?

- A. That the Cārvāka contradicts scripture, which is self-refuting for any Indian school.
- B. That the Cārvāka's hedonism contradicts his materialism.

- C. That the Cārvāka's acceptance of perception contradicts his acceptance of the four elements.
- D. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a **universal** proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sharma states the charge at length, concluding that "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy." A confuses heterodoxy with incoherence. B and C name tensions that are not the self-refutation charge — and C is not a tension at all, since the four elements are perceptible.

MEMORY: Trap: the sharpest form of the charge is the **other-minds** point, and it is the one most often omitted.

MCQ 17 — Anvaya and vyatireka

In the Nyāya construction of *vyāpti*, what do *anvaya* and *vyatireka* contribute, and why is the pair stronger than mere counting?

- A. *Anvaya* is agreement in presence — wherever the *hetu*, there the *sādhya*; *vyatireka* is agreement in absence — where the *sādhya* is absent, the *hetu* is absent. Together they make *bhūyodarśana* a **structured search for counter-instances** rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find *hetu*-without-*sādhya* has a warrant that a mere count does not.
- B. *Anvaya* is the major premise and *vyatireka* the minor premise of the five-membered syllogism.
- C. *Anvaya* is perception and *vyatireka* is inference.
- D. *Anvaya* is the elimination of *upādhis* and *vyatireka* is hypothetical reasoning.

Answer: A

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*), supportive reasoning (*tarka*) and elimination of *upādhi* as the means of establishing *vyāpti*, and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence is the disciplined form the observation takes. B misdescribes the *pañcāvayava* structure; C and D misassign the terms — *upādhi*-elimination and *tarka* are distinct stages.

MEMORY: Trap: the Nyāya answer to Cārvāka is **negative-case testing**, not "we have seen many cases".

MCQ 18 — Tarka

What is *tarka*, and what is its status in Nyāya?

- A. A fifth *pramāṇa* alongside perception, inference, comparison and testimony.
- B. Not a *pramāṇa* at all but a *pramāṇa-anugrāhaka* — an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (*aniṣṭa-prasaṅga*), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of *vyāpti*.
- C. The extraordinary perception through which a universal is presented in a particular.
- D. The technical name for the fallacy of the undistributed middle.

Answer: B

Explanation: Nyāya expressly refuses *tarka* independent *pramāṇa* status while assigning it a decisive doubt-removing role; the authored Nyāya file lists it among the means of establishing *vyāpti* alongside repeated observation and *upādhi*-elimination. A promotes it wrongly; C describes *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*; D confuses a supportive method with a formal fallacy.

MEMORY: Trap: *tarka* proves nothing by itself — say so, and the answer sounds like Nyāya rather than like a summary of Nyāya.

MCQ 19 — Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa

How does Nyāya answer the Cārvāka objection that "smokeness" cannot be perceived because not all smokes are perceived?

- A. By conceding the point and grounding *vyāpti* in scripture instead.
- B. By denying that universals exist.
- C. Through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented *through* any perceived particular — so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.
- D. By arguing that "smokeness" is a mere name with no cognitive content.

Answer: C

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists as a standard trap the claim "that universals are not perceived. Nyāya allows their perception through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**." A abandons Nyāya's insistence that inference is *independent* of testimony; B and D are nominalist positions Nyāya explicitly rejects.

MEMORY: Trap: the device works only inside Nyāya's realism about universals — say so, and your evaluation looks balanced rather than partisan.

MCQ 20 — Parāmarśa

Why does the concept of *parāmarśa* undercut the Cārvāka's description of inference as "a leap in the dark"?

- A. Because *parāmarśa* is a second perception that confirms the first.
- B. Because *parāmarśa* is a scriptural warrant for the inference.
- C. Because *parāmarśa* is the elimination of all *upādhis* prior to inferring.
- D. Because *parāmarśa* is the operative cognition (*karaṇa*) of *anumiti* — the apprehension of the mark **as qualified by** its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") — so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.

Answer: D

Explanation: For Nyāya the inferential cognition is generated by *parāmarśa*, not by a psychological jump from one perception to an absent object. A, B and C misdescribe the concept — respectively as a further perception, a scriptural licence, and a stage of *vyāpti*-formation.

MEMORY: Trap: the memorable contrast — for Cārvāka a jump in the dark, for Nyāya a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.

MCQ 21 — Four elements, not five

Which statement about Cārvāka cosmology is correct?

- A. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects *ākāśa* because it is not perceived but only inferred — from sound to an imperceptible substrate — and inference is not a *pramāṇa*.
- B. Cārvāka admits five elements but denies that they are eternal.
- C. Cārvāka admits *ākāśa* but denies that sound is its quality.
- D. Cārvāka admits only earth and water, treating fire and air as their modifications.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; it has to be inferred." Sharma states the same. B contradicts Sharma's further point that "the elements are **eternal**, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution". C and D have no textual basis.

MEMORY: **Trap:** "five elements" is the single most examined factual error in this syllabus item.

MCQ 22 — Eternity and combination

What is the correct Cārvāka position on the permanence of the elements and of the things composed from them?

- A. Both the elements and their combinations are momentary.
- B. The elements are **eternal**, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" — so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.
- C. The elements are produced by God and are therefore contingent.
- D. The elements are eternal and their combinations are equally eternal, so nothing ever perishes.

Answer: B

Explanation: Sharma states the doctrine exactly, and Chatterjee and Datta supply the biological corollary that living organisms are composed of the four elements, "by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are reduced on death." A imports Buddhist momentariness; C imports a creator the school denies; D contradicts the observed dissolution of bodies.

MEMORY: **Trap:** this is what makes Cārvāka a **realist** materialism and sharpens its contrast with Buddhist *kṣaṇikavāda*.

MCQ 23 — Two analogies, two objections

The betel analogy and the fermentation analogy both support *bhūta-caitanya-vāda*. What distinct work does each do?

- A. Both answer the same objection, that consciousness cannot be perceived.
- B. The betel analogy is Nyāya's and the fermentation analogy Cārvāka's.
- C. The **betel** analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients — leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" — may exhibit a property absent from each; the **fermentation** analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.
- D. The betel analogy establishes that consciousness is a colour and the fermentation analogy that it is a power.

Answer: C

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the two cases with exactly this division of labour — compositional emergence and transformational emergence. B misattributes both; indeed the fermentation case appears in the transmitted *Bṛhaspati sūtra kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*. A collapses two distinct arguments; D is a category confusion.

MEMORY: **Trap:** present them as **two** analogies answering **two** objections, not as one illustration repeated.

MCQ 24 — Pot, potter and svabhāva

An objector argues that a jar requires not only clay (material cause) but a potter (efficient cause), so the four elements need God as the world's shaper. What is the Cārvāka reply, and what labels does it earn?

- A. That the elements are shaped by *adr̥ṣṭa* rather than by God.
- B. That God exists but is the material rather than the efficient cause.
- C. That the analogy fails because jars are perceived and the world is not.
- D. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" — earning the labels **naturalism** (*svabhāvavāda*), **mechanism** (*yadṛcchāvāda*) and, in the textbook's own words, **positivism**, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the exchange and then supply all three labels in the same passage. A retains *adṛṣṭa*, which the school explicitly rejects as an unperceived law. B is Vedāntic, not Cārvāka. C is not the reply given, and would concede the design question.

MEMORY: Trap: note the internal tension worth flagging in an answer — *svabhāva* grounds regularity in fixed natures, while *yadṛcchā* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

MCQ 25 — The formula of dehātmavāda

What does *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* assert, and what does it not assert?

- A. It asserts that the person **is** the body **qualified by consciousness** — that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does **not** assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.
- B. It asserts that consciousness is a fifth element.
- C. It asserts that the body is an instrument used by the self.
- D. It asserts that the self is the *manas* rather than the gross body.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta render the Cārvāka position as "this conscious living body (*caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā*)". B contradicts the four-element doctrine. C is Sharma's *objection* — that the body is "a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness" — not the Cārvāka thesis. D names one of Sadānanda's four materialist variants recorded in the *Vedāntasāra*, not the mainstream formula.

MEMORY: Trap: every word of the formula is load-bearing; "qualified by consciousness" is what makes a body a **self**.

MCQ 26 — The argument from first-person statements

What is the logical force of the Cārvāka appeal to judgements like "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind"?

- A. That such statements are figurative and therefore prove nothing.
- B. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these would be **meaningless** category mistakes — so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.
- C. That the body is the object of self-knowledge but not its subject.
- D. That the soul possesses bodily attributes by inherence.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we have direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame,' 'I am blind'. If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, **these would be meaningless**." A is the dualist's *reply*, not the argument. C and D concede the dualist framework the argument is designed to challenge.

MEMORY: Trap: the argument shifts the burden; it does not by itself prove materialism, and saying so improves the answer.

MCQ 27 — Sharma's objection battery

Which pair of objections, taken together, shows that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes only **dependence** of consciousness on the body rather than **production** by it?

- A. That consciousness is private, and that the Vedas are authorless.
- B. That animals lack rational consciousness, and that the elements are eternal.

C. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen **without** consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation — "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" — so "the body is a mere **instrument** for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".

D. That the *Brhaspati-sūtra* is lost, and that Jayarāśi attacks perception.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sharma advances precisely this pair, and their joint effect is to sever the inference from constant co-occurrence to causation. A pairs a genuine objection with an irrelevant Mīmāṃsā doctrine. B pairs a weaker objection with a doctrine that is not an objection at all. D concerns sources, not the mind–body question.

MEMORY: Trap: the honest verdict is that both sides argue from the same evidence to different best explanations — say so rather than declaring a winner.

MCQ 28 — Cārvāka versus Buddhist denial of self

Which statement differentiates the two denials of *ātman* most precisely?

A. Cārvāka denies the self on soteriological grounds, Buddhism on epistemological grounds.

B. Cārvāka accepts rebirth without a soul; Buddhism denies rebirth.

C. Both deny the self for identical reasons, differing only in vocabulary.

D. Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining a substantial bearer — the living body — on **epistemic** grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such on **ontological and soteriological** grounds (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the *santāna* so that karma, rebirth and *nirvāṇa* are preserved — and since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Answer: D

Explanation: The authored Buddhism file states that Cārvāka "denies self beyond body and tends toward materialist reduction" while Buddhism "denies permanent self but does not reduce personhood simply to gross body", concluding that "both reject an eternal *ātman*, but for very different reasons and with very different moral-metaphysical consequences." A reverses the grounds; B inverts both positions on rebirth; C is the error the 2024 question was set to detect.

MEMORY: Trap: the one-line formula — Cārvāka **relocates** the self, Buddhism **dissolves** it.

MCQ 29 — Adṛṣṭa and transmigration

Why is *adṛṣṭa* the ideal test case for the Cārvāka's epistemic principle, and what does its rejection entail?

A. Because *adṛṣṭa* is by definition "the unseen" — an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility — so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.

B. Because *adṛṣṭa* is accepted only by the Jainas.

C. Because *adṛṣṭa* is a perceptible quality of the soul.

D. Because *adṛṣṭa* is another name for *svabhāva*.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta name it among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and **any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)** cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception." B is false — *adṛṣṭa* is a Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device. C contradicts its definition. D confuses an unseen moral potency with an inherent natural disposition, which is the very substitution the Cārvāka makes *against* it.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *svabhāva* is what the Cārvāka puts in place of *adṛṣṭa*, not a synonym for it.

MCQ 30 — Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ

What is the correct reading of the transmitted *sūtra* "death alone is liberation"?

- A. A recommendation of suicide as the highest human end.
- B. A *reductio* of the very concept of *mokṣa*: if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" — so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".
- C. The Jaina doctrine that liberation is attained at the moment of bodily death.
- D. A ritual prescription for the moment of death.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set out both horns and the residue, adding the decisive clause that no wise man would work for such an end — which by itself refutes A. C attributes a soul the school denies. D restores the ritual efficacy the school rejects.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the verse attacks the **coherence of the goal**, not the value of life.

MCQ 31 — Ethics and the two Cārvākas

Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is accurate on the textbooks' own evidence?

- A. All Cārvākas were gross sensualists, and no source suggests otherwise.
- B. Cārvāka accepts *dharma* and *artha* while rejecting *kāma* and *mokṣa*.
- C. *Kāma* is the ultimate end and *artha* only its **means**, while *dharma* is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the **scriptures**, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and *mokṣa* because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish **dhūrta** (cunning) from **suśikṣita** (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā*, the report that some regarded the **king as God**, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.
- D. Cārvāka ethics is deontological, grounding duty in the fixed natures of things.

Answer: C

Explanation: Every clause is from Chatterjee and Datta, who add that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline" and that the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction "makes it likely that the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type." A ignores that distinction. B inverts the verdict on all four *puruṣārthas*. D is incompatible with a hedonistic value theory.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *dharma* is rejected on **epistemic** grounds — it is a scriptural category — not because pleasure is more agreeable.

MCQ 32 — The positivism verdict

Which is the most defensible verdict on whether Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic?

- A. Straightforwardly yes, since both admit only observable phenomena.
- B. Straightforwardly no, since positivism is a nineteenth-century European movement and cross-traditional comparison is illegitimate.
- C. Yes, because Comte's law of three stages is anticipated in the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*.
- D. Positivistic in **spirit** — an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" — but **not in method**, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies

pramāṇa-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are **radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism**.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta both apply the label and supply the material that qualifies it, since they also record the wholesale denial of inference and compare the Cārvāka view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". A ignores the methodological chasm; B refuses a comparison the tradition of exposition has itself made; C invents a claim about a lost text.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the decisive paradox — Cārvāka reaches a **materialist** conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route, whereas modern materialism reaches it by a thoroughly inferential one.

Part III — Remedial MCQs: Category Errors and Textual-Source Uncertainty

These target the errors that cost the most marks in this syllabus item. They fall into two families: **category errors** (R1–R5), where two philosophically distinct things are treated as one; and **textual and source uncertainty** (R6–R10), where a doxographical report is treated as primary evidence. Attempt them only after Part II.

Remedial R1 — "Denies the self" versus "denies a transcendental self"

A student writes: "Cārvāka, like Buddhism, denies the self." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka denies the **transcendental, immaterial** self and positively affirms a **material** one — *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the body qualified by consciousness — whereas Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such, including the body-self, since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.
- B. Cārvāka denies the self entirely and Buddhism affirms a permanent self.
- C. Both deny the self identically; the difference is only terminological.
- D. Buddhism denies the self only in the Mahāyāna schools.

Answer: A · Note: this is the exact error the 2024 twenty-marker was set to catch. D is also false: pudgala-nairātmya is affirmed by the early realist schools as well; Mahāyāna adds dharma-nairātmya.

Remedial R2 — "Rejects inference" versus "never infers"

A student writes: "According to Cārvāka nobody ever infers anything, since inference is impossible." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka accepts inference as a *pramāṇa* in worldly matters and rejects it only in scripture.
- B. Cārvāka denies inference **as a *pramāṇa***, that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" — and his sharpest target is **transcendental** inference, which no perception could ever check.
- C. Cārvāka rejects perception as well, following Jayarāśi.
- D. Cārvāka rejects inference only when it is used by Naiyāyikas.

Answer: B · Note: the distinction between *pramāṇa*-status and everyday expectation is what makes the position discussable at all. A over-corrects by granting *pramāṇa*-status; C confuses the school with Jayarāśi.

Remedial R3 — Svabhāva versus *adrṣṭa*

A student writes: "Cārvāka explains the world's regularity by *adrṣṭa*, the inherent unseen power of things." Which correction is required?

- A. *Adrṣṭa* is a Cārvāka term meaning the fixed nature of the elements.
- B. Cārvāka accepts *adrṣṭa* but denies *karma*.
- C. ***Adrṣṭa*** is the **unseen moral potency** of Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name — Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like *adrṣṭa*)" among the casualties; what

Cārvāka puts **in its place** is **svabhāva**, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.

D. Both terms are synonyms in classical Indian philosophy.

Answer: C · Note: the two terms are opposites in function — one is a moral unseen, the other a natural disposition. Confusing them destroys the argument of the 2021 question.

Remedial R4 — Upādhi versus incomplete enumeration

A student writes: "The *upādhi* objection is simply the point that we have not observed enough cases." Which correction is required?

A. *Upādhi* is the Nyāya name for the middle term.

B. *Upādhi* means a defect in the form of the syllogism.

C. *Upādhi* applies only to inferences about the future.

D. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of **sample size**, curable in principle by further observation; the **upādhi** objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an **unnoticed condition**, so that what remains uncertified is the **identification of the relevant ground** of the relation — Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden and escape notice**." This is why Nyāya must introduce *tarka* rather than merely more observation.

Answer: D · Note: get the standard example's direction right — one who infers smoke from fire errs, because fire is attended with smoke only where the fuel is wet.

Remedial R5 — Naturalism, mechanism and positivism

A student writes: "Cārvāka's *svabhāva* is a scientific naturalism, and therefore Cārvāka is a positivist." Which correction is required?

A. *Svabhāva* is a **metaphysical refusal of teleology**, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels — naturalism (*svabhāva*), mechanism (*yadṛcchāvāda*, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") — and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed **natures** and calling the world's objects **fortuitous**.

B. *Svabhāva* is a Sāṃkhya doctrine, not a Cārvāka one.

C. Cārvāka has no explanatory principle at all.

D. *Yadṛcchāvāda* means "the doctrine of divine will".

Answer: A · Note: three labels, three different claims. Collapsing them into "Cārvāka was scientific" is the commonest way to lose the 2024 question.

Remedial R6 — What survives of the Bṛhaspati-sūtra

A student writes: "As Bṛhaspati says in his *Sūtra*, earth, water, fire and air are the elements." Which correction is required?

A. The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives complete and may be quoted directly.

B. The **Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost**; about a **dozen** *sūtras* and verses survive only as **quotations in other authors' works**, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the *sūtra* quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" — the content of *prthivyaṣṭejovāyuriti tattvāni* is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.

C. The *sūtra* is genuine but was composed by Cārvāka rather than Bṛhaspati.

D. The *sūtra* is preserved inside the *Tattvopaplavasimha*.

Answer: B · Note: the modal caution costs four words and signals scholarly control. D is false: Jayarāṣi's work is an independent sceptical treatise, not a recension of Bṛhaspati.

Remedial R7 — The "ghee and debt" verse

A student opens an answer: "The Cārvāka scripture says: let a man live happily and feed on ghee even though he runs in debt." Which correction is required?

- A. The verse is quoted from Vātsyāyana's *Kāma-sūtra*.
- B. The verse is a Jain parody with no relation to Cārvāka.
- C. The verse is preserved in the **Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha**, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium — an **opponent's** summary written for refutation — and is not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a **doxographical characterisation** of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.
- D. The verse comes from the *Sāmaññaphala-sutta*.

Answer: C · Note: the authored knowledge file gives the same instruction for the companion line yāvat jīvet sukhaṃ jīvet — a traditional doxographical verse, "not ... a securely locatable quotation from an extant primary Cārvāka text". A is doubly wrong, since Vātsyāyana argues against refusing deferral.

Remedial R8 — Jayarāśi and the standard Cārvāka

A student writes: "Since Jayarāśi shows that perception too is unreliable, the Cārvākas rejected all *pramāṇas*." Which correction is required?

- A. Jayarāśi was not a Cārvāka at all but a Buddhist.
- B. Jayarāśi accepts the four elements and differs from the standard Cārvāka only on ethics.
- C. Jayarāśi's work is lost and cannot be assessed.
- D. Jayarāśi is described as a Cārvāka "of an **extreme type**" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of **perceptual** knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" — so his position is the tradition's internal **limit-case**, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception **alone** is a *pramāṇa*, and using Jayarāśi to state it destroys it.

Answer: D · Note: C is refuted by the publication record — the Oriental Institute of Baroda printed the Tattvopaplavasiṃha in 1940, and it is the "single exception" to the loss of the corpus.

Remedial R9 — One Cārvāka or several?

A student writes: "Cārvāka is a single, uniform doctrine identifying the self with the gross body." Which correction is required?

- A. Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra* records **four** materialist schools, identifying the self respectively with the gross body (*sthūla śarīra*), the senses (*indriya*), the vital breaths (*prāṇa*) and the mental organ (*manas*), all agreeing only in "regarding the soul as a product of matter"; Śāntarākṣita separately reports *Kambalāśvatara* holding that consciousness arises from the body **associated with vital breaths**; and the sources also distinguish *dhūrta* from *suśikṣita* Cārvākas. "Cārvāka" therefore names a **family** of positions.
- B. There were exactly two Cārvāka schools, one theistic and one atheistic.
- C. All Cārvākas identified the self with *manas*.
- D. The plurality is a modern scholarly invention with no textual basis.

Answer: A · Note: this single point simultaneously answers the "crude and undifferentiated" charge and supplies precise, citable internal differentiation.

Remedial R10 — Reading hostile sources responsibly

Which methodological statement should govern the use of doxographical material in a Cārvāka answer?

- A. Hostile sources should be discarded entirely, leaving the school undiscussable.
- B. Because the sources are **refutational**, the **crude** version of any doctrine is the one most likely to have been preserved — Sharma warns that "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted", so an answer should reconstruct the **strongest defensible reading and say that it is doing so**, while noting that the **convergence** of independent Buddhist, Advaita, Jaina and Vedāntic accounts on the same doctrinal core is itself evidence for that core.

C. The *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* should be preferred to all others because it is the longest summary.

D. Hostile sources should be treated as neutral, since doxographers aimed at accuracy.

Answer: B · Note: A is the counsel of despair and is refuted by convergence; D ignores the stated purpose of the texts; C is refuted by Sharma's observation that even that summary "seems to be based on such accounts".

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

This section preserves all **9 verified primary-owned Cārvāka PYQs from 2018–2025**, their demand decoding, complete examiner-grade models, timing skeletons and error penalties, followed by original 10/15/20-mark practice and the answer protocol. The cross-linked 2022 Nyāya question remains a comparison route, not a tenth primary-owned Cārvāka PYQ.

Legacy subtopic exam-application routes

The following material is retained from the layered session so that no EXAM APPLICATION content is lost in the v2 reordering.

1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem — exam application

Answer-writing route: Use the source problem as a two-line methodological qualification in any answer; it is not a reason to avoid stating the standard doctrine.

7. Solved PYQ material — the source problem inside an answer

ANALYSIS: No PYQ asks directly about sources; every PYQ is improved by one sentence about them. Use one of these calibrated formulations:

Marks	Sentence to insert	Where
10	"Since the <i>Bṛhaspati-sūtra</i> is lost, the position is reconstructed from doxographies such as the <i>Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha</i> ."	After the opening definition
15	"Because the sources are refutational, the crude version of any Cārvāka doctrine is the one most likely to have been preserved; the argument below therefore reconstructs the strongest defensible reading."	Before the critical evaluation
20	"The historiographical caution cuts both ways: it forbids confident quotation, but the convergence of Buddhist (<i>Tattvasaṅgraha</i>), Advaita (<i>Vedāntasāra</i>), Jaina (<i>Śaḍ-darśana-samuccaya</i>) and Advaita-adjacent doxographical accounts on the same doctrinal core is itself independent evidence for that core."	In the evaluation paragraph

2. Epistemology — Perception as the Sole Pramāṇa — exam application

Answer-writing route: For an epistemology question, distinguish certainty from practical expectation before evaluating whether perception can stand alone.

No separate topic-owned PYQ is assigned to this subtopic; apply this framework to the linked questions in the final PYQ-routing matrix and solved workbook.

3. The Critique of Inference — Vyāpti, Upādhi, the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation — exam application

Answer-writing route: Write the anti-inference case as a sequence: need for *vyāpti* -> limits of perception -> circularity of inferential proof -> testimony dependence -> *upādhi*.

6. Solved PYQ — 2019, Q6(c), 15 marks: the Socrates syllogism

FACT: Exact question. "What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments."

ANALYSIS: What the question is really testing. Whether the candidate can apply the *vyāpti* critique to a *deductive* syllogism rather than reciting the smoke-and-fire example. The examiner has deliberately chosen a Western textbook syllogism whose validity is not in dispute, in order to see whether the candidate attacks the right thing.

ANALYSIS: Model answer (≈245 words).

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows. The objection is directed at the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions here exactly as *vyāpti* does in Indian inference — an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality.

How is that universal known? Not by **perception**: no one has perceived all men — past, present, future, near and distant. Chatterjee and Datta press exactly this point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Not by **inference**: any inference to the universal would itself require a further universal, generating a *petitio principii* or a regress. Not by **testimony**: testimony's own validity is established only inferentially, and if inference depended on testimony "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence the syllogism is, in Sharma's formulation, an **argument in a circle**: "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal." The deduction merely extracts what induction failed to establish. And *upādhi* deepens the objection: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but embodiment-with-organic-decay under conditions never fully surveyed.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka charge is that the syllogism is **valid but epistemically empty**: it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired. That is a serious charge about induction, though the Cārvāka must still answer how his own universal denial of inference is known.

ANALYSIS: The four things this answer must contain, and no answer without them scores well: (i) explicit refusal to attack validity; (ii) the major premise identified as *vyāpti*; (iii) the three-door argument applied; (iv) the *petitio principii* formulation of deduction plus one line of self-critical balance.

4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference — and a Critically Balanced Verdict — exam application

Answer-writing route: In a Nyāya defence answer, present each repair against a named Cārvāka objection and end with a balanced verdict rather than declaring either side simply victorious.

8. Solved PYQ material — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks, and its exact demand

FACT: Exact question. "Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer."

ANALYSIS: The demand has three distinct limbs and candidates routinely answer only the first:

LIMB 1 : IS IT ACCEPTED? -> a survey across schools (mostly NO)
 LIMB 2 : IF NOT, WHY NOT? -> the reasons, school by school
 LIMB 3 : ARE THEY JUSTIFIED? -> the candidate's own graded verdict

ANALYSIS: The cross-school survey table, which is the backbone of Limb 1 and 2:

School	Accepts anumāna?	Its reason for refusing the Cārvāka
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Yes, as an independent <i>pramāṇa</i>	<i>Anvaya-vyatireka</i> + <i>upādhi</i> -elimination + <i>tarka</i> + <i>sāmānyalakṣaṇa</i> ; and the denial is itself inferential
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	FACT: Yes	<i>Prakṛti</i> , <i>puruṣa</i> and the <i>guṇas</i> are established by inference from perceptible effects; without inference the system cannot begin

School	Accepts anumāna?	Its reason for refusing the Cārvāka
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Yes	Ritual injunction and <i>apūrva</i> require inference; and the Cārvāka's attack on <i>śabda</i> strikes at Mīmāṃsā's foundation
Jainism	FACT: Yes	<i>Matī</i> and <i>śruta</i> knowledge involve inference; and <i>anekāntavāda</i> requires the very universals Cārvāka denies
Buddhism	FACT: Yes (<i>pratyakṣa</i> and <i>anumāna</i>)	Dignāga and Dharmakīrti build an entire logic; and <i>Tattvasaṅgraha</i> attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly
Advaita Vedānta	ANALYSIS: Yes at the <i>vyāvahārika</i> level	Rejects <i>ultimate</i> validity of all <i>pramāṇas</i> including perception — a level-distinction Cārvāka lacks

ANALYSIS: **Limb 3 — the graded verdict to write.** *The other systems are justified in rejecting the strong Cārvāka thesis, because a wholesale denial of inference is self-defeating and would abolish the very discourse in which it is stated. They are not entitled to treat the objection as disposed of, because Nyāya's positive account replaces the demand for certainty with a demand for warrant — a substitution that answers the Cārvāka only if fallibilism is accepted, which is itself a concession to him. The correct verdict is therefore that Cārvāka loses the war and wins a battle: inference survives as a **pramāṇa**, but it survives as a warranted rather than an indubitable one.*

5. Metaphysics and Materialism — Four Bhūtas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Svabhāva-vāda — exam application

Answer-writing route: For materialism, derive the four elements, emergent consciousness and rejection of *ākāśa* from the epistemic premise; use both betel and fermentation analogies with their limits.

No separate topic-owned PYQ is assigned to this subtopic; apply this framework to the linked questions in the final PYQ-routing matrix and solved workbook.

6. Self, Body and Consciousness — Dehātmavāda, and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks) — exam application

Answer-writing route: In the 2024 comparison, use a shared-denial/different-reconstruction structure: both reject permanent *ātman*, but Cārvāka affirms the body-self while Buddhism analyses a causal aggregate-stream.

5. Solved PYQ — 2024, Q6(a), 20 marks: Cārvāka versus Buddhist rejection of ātmā

FACT: **Exact question.** *"Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā."*

ANALYSIS: **Demand decoding.** The directive is *differentiate*. The examiner is testing whether the candidate knows that two denials of *ātman* can be philosophically opposite. The commonest failure is a script that says "both deny the soul" and then describes each separately. That earns the marks of a definition, not of a comparison.

ANALYSIS: **The comparison matrix — the core of the answer:**

Axis	Cārvāka	Buddhism
Formal name of the doctrine	FACT: <i>Dehātmavāda</i> — the body is the self	FACT: <i>Anātman</i> / <i>nairātmyavāda</i> — no self-substance
What is denied	FACT: That the self is a transcendental, immaterial, separable category	FACT: That there is any permanent, unchanging, substantial self at all
What is affirmed in its place	FACT: A material self: <i>caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ</i>	FACT: Five <i>skandhas</i> — <i>rūpa</i> , <i>vedanā</i> , <i>saṃjñā</i> , <i>saṃskāra</i> , <i>vijñāna</i> — with no owner
Underlying ground of the denial	FACT: Epistemological: the soul is never perceived, and perception alone is a <i>pramāṇa</i>	FACT: Ontological–soteriological: <i>pratītyasamutpāda</i> and <i>kṣaṇikavāda</i> leave no room for a permanent entity; and belief in self generates <i>trṣṇā</i> and <i>duḥkha</i>

Axis	Cārvāka	Buddhism
Status of consciousness	FACT: An epiphenomenon , a by-product of the organised body	FACT: <i>Vijñāna</i> is one <i>skandha</i> among five — conditioned, momentary, not a product of matter
Is a substance retained?	FACT: Yes — substance is relocated into matter	FACT: No — substance is abolished ; only process remains
Continuity across time	ANALYSIS: Bodily-psychological continuity of one organism	FACT: <i>Santāna</i> , the causal stream; <i>pratisandhāna</i> ; <i>ālaya-vijñāna</i> in Yogācāra
Chariot / analogies	ANALYSIS: Betel and fermentation — emergence of a novel quality	FACT: The chariot : "chariot" is a name for an arrangement of parts; so is "person"
Rebirth	FACT: Rejected — death is the end of the individual	FACT: Accepted — rebirth without a transmigrating self
Karma	FACT: Rejected as an unseen moral force	FACT: Accepted as causal-moral continuity across the stream
Liberation	FACT: No mokṣa ; "death alone is liberation" (<i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>)	FACT: Nirvāṇa is the central soteriological goal
Ethical consequence	ANALYSIS: This-worldly prudence; <i>kāma</i> and <i>artha</i>	FACT: The eightfold path; compassion; extinction of craving
Internal foil within the tradition	ANALYSIS: Sadānanda's four materialist identifications: body, senses, <i>prāṇa</i> , <i>manas</i>	FACT: Puggalavāda (Vātsīputrīyas): a <i>pudgala</i> neither identical with nor different from the <i>skandhas</i> — criticised by the mainstream as a relapse into self-theory

ANALYSIS: **The four differentiating theses to state explicitly** — this is the part that converts the table into an answer:

1. DIFFERENT TARGETS. Carvaka denies a TRANSCENDENTAL self and substitutes a MATERIAL one. Buddhism denies a SUBSTANTIAL self of ANY kind, material or immaterial -- so the Buddhist critique applies to Carvaka's body-self as well.
2. DIFFERENT GROUNDS. Carvaka's ground is EPISTEMIC (unperceived). Buddhism's ground is ONTOLOGICAL (dependent origination and momentariness) and SOTERIOLOGICAL (self-belief generates craving).
3. DIFFERENT AFTERMATHS. Carvaka's denial TERMINATES the moral narrative at death. Buddhism's denial is engineered PRECISELY to preserve karma and rebirth without an owner.
4. DIFFERENT METAPHYSICAL PRICES. Carvaka must explain how matter yields subjectivity. Buddhism must explain how a stream without an owner yields memory, responsibility and liberation.

ANALYSIS: **Model conclusion for the 20-marker.** *Both schools reject the ātman, but the rejections are not species of a single genus. Cārvāka's is a reductive relocation of the self into perceptible matter, driven by an epistemic restriction and terminating in mortality; Buddhism's is a dissolution of substance into a conditioned process, driven by dependent origination and terminating in nirvāṇa. Indeed the Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka as decisively as it refutes Nyāya, since a body-self is still a self. The correct verdict is that Cārvāka denies the transcendence of the self while retaining its substantiality; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its moral continuity.*

7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities — God, Soul, Karma, Rebirth, Heaven, Mokṣa, Veda and Ritual — exam application

Answer-writing route: For the 2021 'bearing' question, draw the derivation from perception-only epistemology to each rejected transcendent entity; do not submit two disconnected lists.

7. Solved PYQ — 2021, Q5(e), 10 marks

FACT: Exact question. "Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them."

ANALYSIS: Demand decoding. The key word is **bearing** — the examiner wants the *derivation*, not two separate lists. A script that describes the epistemology in one paragraph and the denials in another has not answered the question, however accurate each paragraph is.

ANALYSIS: Model answer (≈160 words).

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *pramāṇa*: *anumāna* fails because *vyāpti* can be established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); and *śabda* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" this epistemological conclusion.

The bearing is immediate and systematic. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound, not perceived. *Ātman* falls because no soul is ever perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls because he is reached only by design-inference, and *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Karma*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall because each is either an unseen force or a post-mortem state that no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: Verdict to append if space allows: the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the epistemic premise is itself vulnerable, so the entire ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning — and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks) — exam application

Answer-writing route: For ethics or the 2020 Jaina comparison, separate doctrine, source caution and evaluation; explicitly distinguish crude from refined Cārvāka.

6. Solved PYQ — 2020, Q7(c), 15 marks: Cārvāka versus Jaina conceptions of reality

FACT: Exact question. "Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism."

ANALYSIS: Demand decoding. The axis is **conception of reality** — metaphysics and the epistemology that licenses it — not ethics, and not "materialism versus spirituality" as a slogan. The best answers run four or five explicit axes.

ANALYSIS: The comparison matrix:

Axis	Cārvāka	Jainism
Number of <i>pramāṇas</i>	FACT: One — <i>pratyakṣa</i> alone	FACT: Several; knowledge is fivefold — <i>matī</i> , <i>śruta</i> , <i>avadhi</i> , <i>manaḥparyāya</i> , <i>kevala</i>
Basic definition of the real	ANALYSIS: Whatever is perceptible; matter in combination	FACT: <i>Sat</i> = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya — origination, decay and persistence together
Ultimate constituents	FACT: Four <i>bhūtas</i> : earth, water, fire, air	FACT: Six <i>dravyas</i> : <i>jīva</i> , <i>pudgala</i> , <i>dharma</i> , <i>adharma</i> , <i>ākāśa</i> , <i>kāla</i>
<i>Ākāśa</i>	FACT: Rejected — inferred, not perceived	FACT: Accepted as a distinct <i>dravya</i> providing accommodation
Souls	FACT: None; the self is the living body	FACT: Infinitely many <i>jīvas</i> , each intrinsically conscious; consciousness is the soul's inseparable essence , not (as the Cārvākas hold) "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions"

Axis	Cārvāka	Jainism
Substance and mode	ANALYSIS: Elements eternal, combinations transient; no developed <i>guṇa-paryāya</i> analysis	FACT: Every <i>dravya</i> has <i>guṇa</i> (essential qualities) and <i>paryāya</i> (modes); the gold-ornament example
Truth and standpoint	ANALYSIS: Single standpoint; no level-distinction at all	FACT: Anekāntavāda — reality is many-faced; nayavāda and syādvāda ; the seven-fold predication
Attitude to universals	ANALYSIS: Denied — Sharma notes the Jaina charge that materialism views "particulars alone as real and universals as unreal"	FACT: Real, though standpoint-conditioned
Karma	FACT: Rejected as an unseen force	FACT: Accepted, and uniquely as subtle material substance adhering to the <i>jīva</i> ; <i>bhāvabandha</i> and <i>dravyabandha</i>
Liberation	FACT: None; <i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	FACT: <i>Mokṣa</i> through the three jewels and the five <i>mahāvratas</i> ; <i>kevala-jñāna</i>
Overall type	ANALYSIS: Materialist monism of substance, pluralist only about elemental kinds	FACT: Realistic and relativistic pluralism — "common-sense realism and pluralism"
Shared ground	FACT: Both are <i>nāstika</i> — both reject Vedic authority; both are realists about the perceptible world; both reject a creator God	

ANALYSIS: **The two sentences that lift this answer above a list.**

1. *The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each allows: Jainism's anekāntavāda multiplies both entities and points of view, while Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and the barest possible furniture — and this is why Jainism can accommodate change and persistence together while Cārvāka must simply assert that the elements are eternal and their combinations are not.*
2. *Their agreement is as instructive as their disagreement: both are nāstika, both are realists about the perceptible world, and both refuse a creator God — so the classification "nāstika" tells you almost nothing about a school's metaphysics.*

9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture — exam application

Answer-writing route: Select the answer architecture by marks, reconstruct before criticising, and use a graded verdict tied to the exact directive word.

6. Answer architecture

ANALYSIS: **10 marks (≈150 words, 7–8 minutes)**

1 min : thesis -- perception alone is pramana; ontology is its shadow
4 min : the three doors against vyapti (perception / inference / testimony)
1 min : ONE sharp addition -- upadhi, or the self-refutation charge
1 min : verdict linking epistemology to the denial in question

ANALYSIS: **15 marks (≈220–260 words, 12–13 minutes)**

1 min : frame -- Carvaka as the radical empiricist challenge within Indian philosophy, known through hostile doxography
4 min : full anti-inference argument: vyapti, class-character reply, upadhi, petitio principii
3 min : the rival's positive case (Nyaya's ladder, or Jaina reality, or the objection set on the self)
3 min : Carvaka's best reply, and its cost
1 min : graded verdict with a NAMED criterion

ANALYSIS: **20 marks (≈320–360 words, 17–18 minutes)**

2 min : classify -- epistemology generating metaphysics; note the source problem
5 min : theory of knowledge in full, with the three doors and upadhi
4 min : the ontological consequences -- akasa, atman, isvara, karma, moksa
4 min : the comparison the question demands, run on NAMED AXES
2 min : two objections with replies and residual pressure

7. PYQ routing — the complete 2018–2025 map

Year	Q	Marks	Demand	Session route
2018	Q8(b)	15	Is Cārvāka's rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems? Are they justified?	Subtopics 3 + 4 (three limbs)
2019	Q5(c)	10	Are the Cārvākas consistent in holding that inference is not a source of knowledge?	Subtopic 3 §7
2019	Q6(c)	15	What is wrong, according to the Cārvākas, with the Socrates syllogism?	Subtopic 3 §6
2020	Q6(b)	15	Rejection of <i>ākāśa</i> ; criticism of transmigration	Subtopics 5 §3 + 7 §4
2020	Q7(c)	15	Differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism	Subtopic 8 §6
2021	Q5(e)	10	The bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities	Subtopic 7 §7
2024	Q5(a)	10	Is Cārvāka's philosophy positivistic in nature?	Subtopic 9 §4
2024	Q6(a)	20	Cārvāka's refutation of self versus the Buddhist rejection of <i>ātmā</i>	Subtopic 6 §5
2025	Q5(a)	10	The ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference	Subtopic 3 §§1–5
Cross-link	2022 Q7(c)	15	Nyāya's response to Cārvāka's objections against <i>anumāna</i> (owned by Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika)	Subtopic 4

ANALYSIS: **Pattern to notice.** Five of the nine owned parts concern **inference**. Two concern the **self and transcendent entities**. One concerns **comparison with Jainism**, one the **positivism label**. The topic's centre of gravity is unambiguously epistemological — so a candidate who has mastered Subtopics 2, 3 and 4 has covered the majority of the historical demand.

8. Original practice — Mains questions for this session

ANALYSIS: Attempt these under time before consulting the workbook, which contains full model solutions.

- (10) Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *śabda* as an independent *pramāṇa*, and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception.
- (10) "*Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*." Explain the argument compressed in this Cārvāka *sūtra* and evaluate it.
- (10) Distinguish *svabhāvavāda* from *yadṛcchāvāda* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent.
- (15) Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces.
- (15) "The Cārvāka's *upādhi* objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss.
- (15) Assess whether the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction rescues Cārvāka ethics from the charge of crude hedonism.
- (15) How far do the surviving sources permit a fair reconstruction of Cārvāka philosophy? Discuss with reference to the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, the doxographies and the *Tattvopaplavasīmha*.
- (20) "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate.
- (20) Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *vyāpti*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka.
- (20) Compare the conceptions of reality in Cārvāka and Jainism, and assess which better accounts for change and persistence.

9. Model philosophical conclusion

ANALYSIS: "Cārvāka is the limiting case of Indian philosophy: the position obtained when a single epistemic restriction — that only what is perceived may be admitted — is applied without exception. Everything else follows. Four elements and not five, because ākāśa is inferred; a body-self and not an ātman, because no soul is perceived; nature and not God, because svabhāva discharges the explanatory work; kāma and not dharma, because virtue is a scriptural category. Its failure is that the restriction cannot be stated without being violated: the denial of inference is itself a universal, and the very act of arguing presupposes the other minds that perception never delivers. Its success is that no Indian school could afford to ignore it. Chatterjee and Datta are right that the Cārvāka became the touchstone on which every system tested its theories, and Sharma is right that materialism, born in discontent, soon died in serious thought. Both verdicts hold, because Cārvāka failed as a system precisely to the degree that it succeeded as a challenge."

Part I — All 9 Verified Topic-Owned PYQs (2018–2025)

Corpus note: FACT: The audited Paper I corpus for 2018–2025 contains **9 primary-owned question-parts** for Cārvāka, out of 112 parts overall. The corpus is continuous across all eight years; Cārvāka has no primary-owned part only in **2022** and **2023**. The 2022 Q7(c) question on the Naiyāyika response to Cārvāka's objections against *anumāna* is **primary-owned by Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika** and is therefore treated in the learning session (Subtopic 4) rather than duplicated here.

#	Year	Q	Marks	Theme
1	2018	Q8(b)	15	Rejection of inference and the other systems
2	2019	Q5(c)	10	Consistency of rejecting inference
3	2019	Q6(c)	15	The Socrates syllogism
4	2020	Q6(b)	15	Rejection of <i>ākāśa</i> ; criticism of transmigration
5	2020	Q7(c)	15	Cārvāka versus Jaina conception of Reality
6	2021	Q5(e)	10	Epistemology and the rejection of transcendental entities
7	2024	Q5(a)	10	Is Cārvāka's philosophy positivistic?
8	2024	Q6(a)	20	Cārvāka's refutation of self versus Buddhist rejection of <i>ātmā</i>
9	2025	Q5(a)	10	The ground for rejecting inference

ANALYSIS: **Pattern.** Five of the nine parts concern **inference**. Mastery of the three-door argument, *upādhi* and the self-refutation exchange therefore covers the majority of the historical demand.

PYQ 1 — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? — a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? — the <i>reasons</i> , school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? — the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference ; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point — that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal — survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	<i>Vyāpti</i> ; the three doors; <i>upādhi</i> ; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Model answer (~250 words)

The Cārvāka holds that *anumāna* is not a *pramāṇa*, because *vyāpti* cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a *petitio principii*; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred — and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". *Upādhi* deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that *vyāpti* is built by *anvaya-vyatireka*, elimination of suspected *upādhis*, *tarka* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, and that *parāmarśa* — the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance — means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since *prakṛti* and *puruṣa* are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since injunction and *apūrva* presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the *Tattvasaṅgraha* attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for *matī* and *śrūta*. Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies **ultimate** validity to perception as well — a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant — a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument -> survey the schools with **distinct** reasons -> the self-refutation charge -> the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*, *anvaya-vyatireka*, *tarka*, *parāmarśa*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".
- **Distinction:** rejection of inference as *pramāṇa* versus rejection of practical inference — flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- **Comparison:** at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- **Criticism:** self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.
- **Balance:** one sentence acknowledging that Advaita and Śūnyavāda partly share the Cārvāka's suspicion, but at a different level.
- **Conclusion:** name the criterion. "Justified against the strong thesis; the residual logical point survives."

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Thesis -- anumana is not a pramana; vyapti is the target
3 min : Three doors + upadhi, as numbered steps
4 min : Cross-school survey: Nyaya (full ladder), Samkhya, Mimamsa, Buddhism, Jainism, Advaita (the partial exception)
2 min : Self-refutation charge, reconstructed
2 min : Carvaka's best reply -- the softened certainty-thesis
1 min : Graded verdict with a named criterion
Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering only Limb 1 and omitting the candidate's own verdict: **loses the entire third limb, worth roughly a third of the marks.**
- Giving one generic reason for all schools: **shows no school-specific knowledge.**
- Writing "Cārvāka says nobody ever infers": **factually wrong; the sources record the opposite concession.**
- Presenting the self-refutation charge as decisive without the reply: **fails the implicit "critically" demand.**
- Placing Advaita on the Cārvāka's side without the level-distinction: **a serious doctrinal error.**
- Drifting into hedonism or the ritual polemic: **out of scope, and it costs time.**

PYQ 2 — 2019, Q5(c), 10 marks

Exact question

"Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Discuss</i> with an explicit verdict on consistency — a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence , not about whether inference is in fact valid
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading — but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Model answer (≈165 words)

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a **universal**, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential — and self-defeating — or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. ANALYSIS: Three are available. (i) *Vitaṇḍā*: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty — but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The **softened thesis**: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield **apodictic certainty**, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The **level-distinction**: concede *vyāvahārika* validity, deny the *pāramārthika* — though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict**: inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be **radical or consistent, but not both.**

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure**: state the charge as numbered steps -> give the replies -> deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the *vyāpti* argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- **Doctrine**: the exact form of the thesis being tested — "no inference is a *pramāṇa*" — and its universality.

- **Argument:** the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- **Distinction:** *pramāṇa*-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- **Technical terms:** *viṭaṇḍā*, *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*, *pramāṇa*.
- **Criticism:** the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.
- **Balance:** note that Śūnyavāda and Advaita escape the charge precisely because they *do* have a level-distinction.
- **Conclusion:** a two-sided verdict, not a flat "yes" or "no". The one-line formula is worth memorising.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : State the thesis precisely, as a universal
 2 min : The charge, in four numbered steps + the other-minds point
 2 min : Replies (i), (ii), (iii), each with one line of assessment
 1 min : Note that Sunyavada/Advaita escape via level-distinction
 1 min : Graded verdict -- radical or consistent, not both
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Spending the answer re-narrating the three doors: **answers the 2025 question, not this one.**
- Concluding "yes, consistent" without engaging the charge: **the question is built on the charge.**
- Concluding "no, inconsistent" and stopping: **omits the replies, so the discussion is one-sided.**
- Attributing the level-distinction to Cārvāka as historical doctrine: **factually wrong; label it a repair.**
- Omitting that the Cārvāka must argue, and arguing presupposes other minds: **loses the sharpest form of the objection.**

PYQ 3 — 2019, Q6(c), 15 marks

Exact question

"What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis — application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise , not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty — it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as <i>vyāpti</i> ; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; <i>petitio principii</i> ; <i>upādhi</i> ; one line of self-critical balance

Model answer (~250 words)

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as *vyāpti* does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about **this** particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal — *petitio principii*, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an **argument in a circle**: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. *Upādhi* deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction — though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** disclaim the attack on validity -> identify the major premise as *vyāpti* -> run the three doors **on this premise** -> *petitio principii* -> *upādhi* -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *sāmānya* / class-character, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- **Technical terms:** major premise as *vyāpti*; *sādhya* and *hetu*; *anumāna* and *pramāṇa*.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Nyāya would answer with *anvaya-vyatireka*, *tarka* and *parāmarśa*.
- **Balance:** one self-critical line on the Cārvāka's own position.
- **Conclusion:** "valid but epistemically empty" is the precise register the examiner rewards.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : "The objection is not to validity" -- say it first
2 min : Identify "All men are mortal" as the *vyapti*
5 min : Three doors applied to that premise; add the class-character reply
2 min : *Petitio principii*; induction and deduction cure each other
2 min : *Upadhi* -- is man-ness really the relevant ground?
1 min : One line of Nyaya rejoinder + verdict
Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism **invalid: the single most penalised error in this question.**
- Reciting the smoke-and-fire example without transferring the argument to "All men are mortal": **the examiner set a Western syllogism precisely to test transfer.**
- Omitting *petitio principii*: **loses Sharma's crisp formulation of the deductive half.**
- Omitting *upādhi*: **loses the deepest layer of the critique.**
- Ending without any self-critical line: **the "justify with arguments" demand implies evaluation.**

PYQ 4 — 2020, Q6(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate and examine</i> — two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice , once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let <i>ākāśa</i> consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong — and as vulnerable — as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to- <i>ākāśa</i> inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Model answer (≈255 words)

Ākāśa. FACT: Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four — earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: *ākāśa* "is not perceived but **inferred**" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument — sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore *ākāśa* exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a *pramāṇa*, that route is closed.

ANALYSIS: **Critical evaluation.** The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that *ākāśa* is a **theoretical posit**, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements *as substances*, so he cannot refuse the substance–quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air — a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. FACT: Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: *dehātmavāda* makes the self the living body — *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *karma* and *adrṣṭa* are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

ANALYSIS: **Examination.** Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates. Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production — "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** one epistemic cut, applied twice — and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- **Doctrine:** four *bhūtas*; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; *dehātmavāda*; *adrṣṭa*.
- **Argument:** the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- **Distinction:** rejecting *ākāśa* as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *bhūta*, *adrṣṭa*, *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *pramāṇa*.
- **Criticism:** at least two — the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.
- **Comparison:** one line on Vaiśeṣika's nine *dravyas* or Jainism's six, to make the four-element claim vivid.
- **Conclusion:** name the unifying thesis — one argument, two applications.

Compact skeleton and timing

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1 min : Frame -- ontology is epistemology's shadow
3 min : Akasa: four vs five elements; the Vaishesika inference; its refusal
2 min : Critical evaluation of the akasa half, including the cost
3 min : Transmigration: the four requirements, each cut
3 min : Examination -- strengths and the three weaknesses
1 min : Unifying verdict
Total : 13 minutes

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Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "five elements": **the single most examined factual trap in this syllabus item.**

- Treating the two halves as unrelated: **misses the thesis that unifies the answer.**
- Pure exposition with no evaluation: **the directive is "critically evaluate"; expect heavy penalty.**
- Saying Cārvāka "does not know of" *ākāśa*: **he knows the argument and refuses it.**
- Omitting *adr̥ṣṭa* by name: **it is the perfect test case, since its name means "the unseen".**
- Confusing the Cārvāka's denial of transmigration with the Buddhist denial of a transmigrating self: **entirely different positions; Buddhism accepts rebirth.**

PYQ 5 — 2020, Q7(c), 15 marks

Exact question

"Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the differences</i> — a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality : what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits — Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	<i>Pramāṇas</i> ; the definition of <i>sat</i> ; four <i>bhūtas</i> versus six <i>dravyas</i> ; <i>ākāśa</i> ; soul and consciousness; <i>anekāntavāda</i> and <i>syādvāda</i> ; karma; liberation; and the shared <i>nāstika</i> ground

Model answer (~255 words)

Epistemic root. FACT: Cārvāka admits one *pramāṇa*, *pratyakṣa*. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge — *matī*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* — and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. FACT: For Jainism, *sat* is **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya** — origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as *dravya* while its *paryāyas* change. Cārvāka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. FACT: Four *bhūtas* for Cārvāka; **six dravyas** for Jainism — *jīva*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*. *Ākāśa* is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. FACT: Cārvāka: no *jīva*; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many *jīvas*, with consciousness their **inseparable essence** — expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. FACT: Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Karma and liberation. FACT: Jainism: karma as **subtle matter** adhering to the *jīva*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*, with *mokṣa* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*. Cārvāka: no karma, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Their agreement is instructive: both are *nāstika*, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances — which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- **Doctrine:** *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*; six *dravyas*; *guṇa* and *paryāya*; *anekānta*, *naya*, *syādvāda*; four *bhūtas*.
- **Argument:** show that the metaphysical divergence is *generated* by the epistemic divergence.

- **Distinction:** Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are **media of motion and rest**, not merit and demerit — a classic trap.
- **Technical terms:** *sat*, *dravya*, *jīva*, *pudgala*, *bhūta*, *kevala-jñāna*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*.
- **Comparison:** at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.
- **Balance:** the shared *nāstika*, realist and non-theistic ground must appear, or the answer reads as caricature.
- **Conclusion:** the standpoint thesis, and the change-and-persistence point.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Frame -- epistemic root generates the metaphysical divergence
 2 min : Pramanas: one vs fivefold knowledge
 2 min : Definition of the real: utpada-vyaya-dhauvya vs elemental permanence
 2 min : Constituents: 4 bhutas vs 6 dravyas; akasa
 2 min : Soul and consciousness: emergent by-product vs inseparable essence
 2 min : Anekantavada, nayavada, syadvada vs single standpoint
 1 min : Karma and liberation
 1 min : Shared ground + unifying verdict
 Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering "materialism versus spirituality": **a slogan, not a comparison; heavily penalised at 15 marks.**
- Writing two separate accounts with no cross-reference: **the directive is "differences", which requires axes.**
- Translating Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* as virtue and vice: **a factual error the examiner watches for.**
- Omitting *ākāśa*: **it is the sharpest single contrast available.**
- Saying Jainism holds consciousness to be produced: **it is the soul's inseparable essence, and Jain sources deny the Cārvāka view by name.**
- Omitting the shared ground: **loses the evaluative sophistication that lifts the answer.**

PYQ 6 — 2021, Q5(e), 10 marks

Exact question

"Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Comment on the bearing</i> — the examiner wants the derivation , not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the <i>vyāpti</i> argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Model answer (≈165 words)

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *pramāṇa*: *anumāna* fails because *vyāpti* is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); *śabda* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" this epistemological conclusion.

The **bearing** is systematic. The bridging principle — ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas* — is then applied without exception. *Ākāśa* falls, being inferred from sound. *Ātman* falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls, being reached only by design-inference while *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Karma*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: **Comment:** the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** epistemology compressed into one paragraph -> the bridging principle -> the derivation, entity by entity -> one evaluative line.
- **Doctrine:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*; the bridging principle; *svabhāvavāda*.
- **Argument:** the derivation must read as a *consequence*, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".
- **Distinction:** the bridging principle is a **presupposition**, not a theorem — an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *ātman*, *Īśvara*, *karma*, *adrṣṭa*, *svarga*, *mokṣa*, *śabda*.
- **Comparison:** if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep *karma* and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.
- **Conclusion:** the vulnerability is located in the premise, not in the denials.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Thesis -- ontology is the shadow of epistemology
 2 min : Compressed anti-inference and anti-sabda argument
 1 min : Name the bridging principle AS a presupposition
 2 min : Derive: akasa, atman, isvara, karma/adrsta, rebirth, svarga, moksa, Veda, ritual
 1 min : Evaluative comment
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Two disconnected paragraphs, epistemology then denials: **the word "bearing" is precisely what such an answer misses.**
- Listing entities without connectives: **reads as a catalogue, not a derivation.**
- Spending five of seven minutes on *vyāpti*: **wrong allocation for a 10-marker on the bearing.**
- Omitting *adrṣṭa*: **the best single illustration of the principle.**
- No evaluative line: **"comment" invites one.**

PYQ 7 — 2024, Q5(a), 10 marks

Exact question

"Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications — a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit , not in method ; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Model answer (≈165 words)

ANALYSIS: **Yes in spirit, no in method.**

The case for. FACT: The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in **positive facts or observable phenomena**", and compare

its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, *karma* and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "**meaningless**".

The case against. ANALYSIS: Positivism is built on **inference** — science is systematised inference — which Cārvāka denies *pramāṇa*-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. **Radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism** is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** verdict first -> case for -> case against -> refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- **Doctrine:** the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason — this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- **Argument:** the inference divergence must be identified as the **decisive** disanalogy, not listed among equals.
- **Distinction:** spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- **Technical terms:** *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *pramāṇa*, *svabhāvavāda*, verification, unobservables.
- **Comparison:** at least one named Western reference point — Comte or Ayer — used precisely.
- **Balance:** note the "meaningless" register as genuine support for the label, and then explain why it still does not settle the matter.
- **Conclusion:** offer the better label rather than merely refusing the given one.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Verdict -- positivistic in spirit, not in method
2 min : For: textbook's own label; empiricist criterion; anti-metaphysics;
anti-authority; naturalistic ethics; "meaningless" register
2 min : Against: inference; unobservables; no constructive programme;
no formal tools; no Comtean content
1 min : Refined label + the anti-inferential paradox
Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- A flat "yes": **ignores the decisive divergence over inference.**
- A flat "no": **ignores that the standard textbook applies the label itself.**
- Refusing all cross-cultural comparison: **evades the question rather than answering it.**
- Long exposition of Comte or Ayer: **the question is about Cārvāka.**
- Not offering an alternative label: **loses the constructive half of the "justifications" demand.**

PYQ 8 — 2024, Q6(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Differentiate</i> — sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of <i>ātman</i> can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in karma, rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	<i>Dehātmavāda</i> with its formula; the five <i>skandhas</i> ; <i>santāna</i> ; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that <i>rūpa</i> is itself a <i>skandha</i> ; the divergent aftermaths

Model answer (≈345 words)

Both schools reject the *ātman* of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. FACT: The doctrine is *dehātmavāda* — *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The **ground is epistemological**: perception alone is a *pramāṇa*, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an **emergent by-product** of the organised elements — as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *karma*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* all lapse, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

Buddhism: dissolution. FACT: *Anātman* denies not the transcendence but the **substantiality** of the self. The person is analysed into five *skandhas* — *rūpa*, *vedanā*, *saṃjñā*, *saṃskāra*, *viññāna* — with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The **ground is ontological and soteriological**: *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda* leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by *santāna*, the causal stream, with *pratisandhāna* and, in Yogācāra, *ālaya-viññāna* bearing *bījas*. Hence karma and rebirth survive **without** a self, and *nirvāṇa* remains the goal.

ANALYSIS: **The four differentiating theses.** (i) **Targets** differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind — and since *rūpa* is itself one of the *skandhas*, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**. (ii) **Grounds** differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) **Aftermaths** differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) **Prices** differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its **moral continuity**.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** the two positions stated compactly -> four explicit differentiating theses -> a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.
- **Doctrine:** *dehātmavāda* with the Sanskrit formula; the five *skandhas* named in order; *santāna*; *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda*.
- **Argument:** the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- **Distinction:** transcendence versus substantiality — this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- **Technical terms:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *anātman* / *nairātmyavāda*, *pudgala-nairātmya*, *ālaya-viññāna*, *bīja*.
- **Criticism:** the point that *rūpa* is itself a *skandha*, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly — very few candidates make it.

- **Comparison:** the internal foils, **Puggalavāda** in Buddhism and **Sadānanda's four materialisms** in Cārvāka, are worth one sentence each at 20 marks.
- **Conclusion:** the relocation-versus-dissolution formula, stated crisply.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Frame -- both reject atman, but not in the same way
 5 min : Carvaka: dehatmavada, epistemic ground, first-person argument, emergence analogies, mortality consequence
 5 min : Buddhism: five skandhas, chariot, ontological + soteriological ground, santana / pratisandhana / alaya-vijnana
 4 min : The four differentiating theses, stated as theses
 1 min : Internal foils -- Puggalavada; Sadananda's four materialisms
 1 min : Verdict -- relocation vs dissolution
 Total : 18 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "both deny the soul" and then describing each separately: **the exact error this question was designed to catch.**
- Saying Buddhism reduces the person to the body: **false; rūpa is one of five skandhas and is itself denied selfhood.**
- Saying Cārvāka denies the self altogether: **he denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one.**
- Saying Cārvāka denies consciousness: **he denies its immaterial bearer.**
- Omitting *santāna*, or smuggling a soul into it: **the standard Buddhist device must appear.**
- Missing the aftermath asymmetry: **Cārvāka ends the moral story; Buddhism continues it without an owner.**
- Omitting the Sanskrit formula: **at 20 marks the examiner expects the technical vocabulary.**

PYQ 9 — 2025, Q5(a), 10 marks

Exact question

"Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the ground</i> — a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing <i>vyāpti</i>
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that <i>vyāpti</i> , without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits
Non-negotiables	<i>Vyāpti</i> defined; the three doors; <i>upādhi</i> ; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Model answer (≈165 words)

FACT: The ground is the **impossibility of establishing *vyāpti***. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sādhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance — "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a *pramāṇa*, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own *vyāpti*.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Upādhi completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

ANALYSIS: Hence truth is "only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" in inference — not the guaranteed character a *pramāṇa* requires.

Why this earns marks — what a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- **Structure:** define *vyāpti* -> three doors -> *upādhi* -> the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *liṅga* and *sādhya*, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- **Distinction:** rejection as *pramāṇa* versus everyday expectation — one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- **Technical terms:** at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- **Comparison:** at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.
- **Conclusion:** the "accident and separable" formulation is the sharpest available and should close the answer.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Define *vyapti* and state why inference needs it
 3 min : The three doors, one short paragraph each
 2 min : *Upadhi* -- the wet-fuel case; hidden conditions
 1 min : Conclusion -- truth is accidental and separable in inference
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing about Cārvāka metaphysics or ethics: **out of scope for a tightly focused 10-marker**.
- Giving only "we cannot observe all cases" and stopping: **one door out of three**.
- Omitting *upādhi*: **the deepest layer of the ground is missing**.
- Writing that Cārvāka rejects all reasoning whatsoever: **contradicted by the sources**.
- Spending half the answer on the Nyāya reply: **the question asks for the ground, not the debate**.

Part IV — Ten Original Solved Mains Questions

Distribution: three 10-markers, four 15-markers, three 20-markers. Each carries demand decoding, a model answer written to the appropriate length, and a top-answer checklist. These are the ten questions set as practice at the close of the learning session.

Original 10-marker 1

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *śabda* as an independent *pramāṇa*, and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> then <i>assess</i> — exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Model answer (≈160 words)

FACT: The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference — "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" — and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the **sound**, which is perceived, and the **content**, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent *pramāṇa*-status

without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable — but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly — this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an **inference**.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes **inconsistency** from **impracticality**.

Original 10-marker 2

Question: "Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ." Explain the argument compressed in this Cārvāka *sūtra* and evaluate it. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> the compressed argument, then <i>evaluate</i>
Core issue	That the verse is a <i>reductio</i> of <i>mokṣa</i> , not a recommendation of death
Ideal thesis	It is a coherent dilemma against the <i>concept</i> of liberation, though it presupposes that liberation must be defined as the total cessation of suffering

Model answer (≈165 words)

FACT: The *sūtra* compresses a dilemma. What could *mokṣa* mean? If it means the **freedom of a soul** from bondage to physical existence, it is "absurd because there is no soul" — *dehātmavāda* has already removed the candidate. If it means the attainment **in this life** of a state free from all pain, it is "an impossible ideal", since "existence in this body is bound up with pleasure as well as pain". The only state satisfying the definition of complete cessation of suffering is therefore **death** — and Chatterjee and Datta add the decisive clause that "no wise man would willingly work for that end".

ANALYSIS: **Evaluation.** The argument is valid and its rhetorical force is considerable: it exposes that *mokṣa*, defined negatively as the cessation of suffering, has a trivial satisfier. Its weakness is that most schools define liberation **positively** — as *kevala-jñāna*, *nirvāṇa* or the realisation of Brahman — rather than merely as pain's absence, so the dilemma may be attacking a definition its opponents need not accept.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- Both horns of the dilemma stated, each with its reason.
- The clause "no wise man would work for that end" quoted or paraphrased — it kills the suicide misreading.
- Explicit statement that the verse is a *reductio* of a **concept**.
- The evaluative counter: liberation is often defined **positively** by the rival schools.
- One line linking the verse to *dehātmavāda*, which supplies the first horn.

Original 10-marker 3

Question: Distinguish *svabhāva* from *yadṛcchā* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish</i> then <i>examine</i> consistency — a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if <i>svabhāva</i> governs the behaviour of elements while <i>yadṛcchā</i> governs their initial concurrence ; otherwise there is tension

Model answer (≈165 words)

FACT: **Svabhāvavāda** is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. FACT: **Yadṛcchāvāda** is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or **fortuitous** combination of elements".

ANALYSIS: **Examination.** There is a real tension. If the elements combine **by their fixed natures**, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is **fortuitous**, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: *svabhāva* explains how each element **behaves** once in combination, while *yadṛcchā* denies that any **purpose** governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies **teleology**, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 15-marker 1

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine ... with the objections</i> — exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains — though dualism does not close it either

Model answer (≈245 words)

FACT: **The doctrine.** *Kiṇvādiḥhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. **Betel** — leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together — establishes **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** — molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment — establishes **transformational** emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an **epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter".

ANALYSIS: **Objections.** (i) The analogies concern **public, third-person** qualities; consciousness is **private** — Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists **without** consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related — so the body may be the **instrument** of consciousness rather than its cause.

ANALYSIS: **Replies and verdict.** The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific **organisation** rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely **renames** the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes **dependence**, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- The transmitted *sūtra* quoted or paraphrased.

- Both analogies, with their **distinct** functions named.
- The word *epiphenomenon* used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing **dependence** from **production**.

Original 15-marker 2

Question: "The Cārvāka's *upādhi* objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas <i>upādhi</i> is not

Model answer (~250 words)

FACT: The enumeration objection. *Vyāpti* requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

FACT: The *upādhi* objection. Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from fire and err, having failed to notice the *upādhi* of **wetness of fuel**, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference" — and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden**".

ANALYSIS: Why the second is stronger. Enumeration is a defect of **quantity**: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. *Upādhi* is a defect of **identification**: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical — Nyāya answers enumeration with *bhūyodarśana* and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in **tarka** and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* to address *upādhi*, and concedes that only **suspected** conditions can be eliminated.

ANALYSIS: Counter-consideration and verdict. Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus *tarka* is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the *upādhi* point. The claim therefore stands: *upādhi* is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- Both objections stated accurately, with the *upādhi* example running **fire -> smoke**.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.
- *Tarka* correctly described as an auxiliary, not a *pramāṇa*.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 15-marker 3

Question: Assess whether the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction rescues Cārvāka ethics from the charge of crude hedonism. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Assess — a verdict on whether a historical distinction discharges a philosophical charge
Core issue	Whether refinement of taste supplies a standard of value or only a regulation of pursuit
Ideal thesis	It rescues Cārvāka from the caricature but not from the philosophical charge

Model answer (≈250 words)

FACT: **The charge.** Sharma: "The ethics of the Cārvāka is a **crude individual hedonism**"; the school fell not through atheism or materialism, which it shares with respected schools, but through "the denial of all human values which make life worth living" — and "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher."

FACT: **The distinction.** Chatterjee and Datta record that a distinction "between the cunning (*dhūrta*) and cultured (*suśikṣita*) Cārvākas makes it likely that the Cārvākas were **not all of the same gross, uncultured type**." The supporting evidence is substantial: cultivation of the **sixty-four fine arts**; the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā* into Lokāyata; the report that some Cārvākas "regard the **king as God**", implying faith in society and its head; and Vātsyāyana's *Kāma-sūtra*, "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism", with its insistence on self-control, urbanity and educated senses, and its argument that refusing to defer "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds".

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The distinction rescues Cārvāka from the **caricature**: the historical movement was not uniformly gross, and Chatterjee and Datta themselves note that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline." But it does not discharge the **philosophical** charge. Vātsyāyana's regulation is **prudential** — it maximises pleasure over a lifetime — and supplies no **qualitative** ordering of pleasures and no independent account of other-regarding obligation. Moreover he "believes in God and in life after death", so he is a materialist only "in a wider sense".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** Cārvāka's ethics is a complete theory of **prudence** and an incomplete theory of **morality**.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- Sharma's charge quoted in its strongest form, including the "pleasure of the pig".
- All four items of evidence for refinement, not just Vātsyāyana.
- The caveat that Vātsyāyana is not a materialist in the ordinary sense.
- The distinction between prudential regulation and a qualitative standard of value.
- The prudence/morality verdict, which is the answer's thesis.

Original 15-marker 4

Question: How far do the surviving sources permit a fair reconstruction of Cārvāka philosophy? Discuss with reference to the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, the doxographies and the *Tattvopaplavasiṃha*. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>How far</i> — a calibrated answer, neither "fully" nor "not at all"
Core issue	The evidential value of hostile transmission plus a single unrepresentative surviving text
Ideal thesis	Reconstruction is possible for the doctrinal core through convergence, but not for the school's strongest formulations

Model answer (≈250 words)

FACT: **The evidential situation.** No systematic primary work survives. The *Brhaspati-sūtra* is lost, and about a **dozen** *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors. Chatterjee and Datta: "almost every work of the other schools states, **for refutation**, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma is blunter: "the weak points in this school are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture" — and he adds that even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", so it grants no independent access.

FACT: **The one surviving text.** Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa's *Tattvopaplavaśiṃha* (c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940) is the "single exception". But he is a Cārvāka "of an extreme type" who attacks **perception** itself and refuses even the physical elements, so he cannot testify to the school's defining thesis.

ANALYSIS: **How far, then?** Three conclusions are defensible. (i) **Doctrinal core: reconstructible.** Independent Buddhist (*Tattvasaṃgraha*), Advaita (*Vedāntasāra*), Jaina (*Ṣaḍ-darśana-samuccaya*) and Vedāntic (*Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*) accounts converge on perceptualism, anti-inferentialism, four elements, no soul and no afterlife — and convergence across hostile and mutually opposed witnesses is genuine evidence. (ii) **Strongest formulations: not recoverable.** Where a doctrine has a crude and a defensible version, the crude one is what an opponent preserves. (iii) **Internal diversity: partly visible.** Sadānanda's four materialist schools and the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction show a family rather than a monolith.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** enough for philosophy, not enough for philology — which is why answers should say "on the standard reconstruction".

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- All three source-types treated, as the question specifies.
- The convergence argument, which is what rescues the answer from scepticism.
- Jayarāśi correctly characterised as unrepresentative.
- The internal-diversity evidence used as a positive finding.
- A calibrated verdict, with the recommended answer-writing formula.

Original 20-marker 1

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> a strong interpretive claim — say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials , false of the affirmations — the four elements, emergence and <i>svabhāva</i> are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Model answer (≈350 words)

FACT: **The case for the claim.** Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Ātman* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. *Karma*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

ANALYSIS: **Where the claim fails.** Three points. (i) The derivation needs a **bridging principle** — that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas* — which is a **presupposition**, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal of that gap is a

substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains **positive** theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly **four** elements, that they are **eternal** while their combinations perish, that consciousness **emerges** from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity — none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *pramāṇa*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadr̥cchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** The claim is **true of the negative half and false of the positive half**. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list — which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. ANALYSIS: Criterion named: **derivational economy** supports the claim, **explanatory content** refutes it.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a **presupposition**.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadr̥cchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict — true of the denials, false of the affirmations — with a named criterion.

Original 20-marker 2

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *vyāpti*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Compare</i> then <i>assess success</i> — the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Model answer (≈350 words)

FACT: **Cārvāka.** *Vyāpti* is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". *Upādhi* completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

FACT: **Nyāya.** *Vyāpti* is **assembled**, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as **anvaya** (co-presence) and **vyatireka** (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected *upādhis* are identified and the universal restated at the correct level — "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". **Tarka** — not a *pramāṇa* but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* — assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, **parāmarśa** — the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance — shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Nyāya succeeds on three counts. *Tarka* has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. *Parāmarśa* dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy:

perception errs — the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc — and is corrected **by inference**, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

ANALYSIS: Yet three concessions remain. Only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated. *Tarka* proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Nyāya answers the Cārvāka **by changing the standard** — from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by **warrant**, Nyāya wins; judged by **entailment**, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- *Tarka* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names **two** criteria and delivers a different result under each.

Original 20-marker 3

Question: Compare the conceptions of reality in Cārvāka and Jainism, and assess which better accounts for change and persistence. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Compare then assess on a specified philosophical criterion — change and persistence
Core issue	Whether asserting eternal elements and transient combinations amounts to an account, or merely a juxtaposition
Ideal thesis	Jainism has the superior analysis ; Cārvāka has the superior economy ; on the stated criterion Jainism wins

Model answer (≈355 words)

FACT: **Epistemic root.** Cārvāka admits one *pramāṇa*, perception. Jainism admits fivefold knowledge — *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* — and hence inference. Every later divergence follows.

FACT: **The real.** For Jainism, *sat* is **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya**: origination, decay and persistence **together**. Every *dravya* has *guṇa* (essential qualities) and *paryāya* (modes); gold persists as substance while bracelet gives way to ring. The apparent contradiction — that one thing is both changing and permanent — is resolved by respect: permanence as *dravya*, change as *paryāya*. For Cārvāka, the elements are **eternal** while "their combinations undergo production and dissolution".

FACT: **Constituents and souls.** Four *bhūtas* against **six dravyas** — *jīva*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*; *ākāśa* rejected as inferred against *ākāśa* accepted as a distinct substance. No *jīva* against infinitely many, with consciousness their **inseparable essence**, expressly denying the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

FACT: **Standpoint, karma, liberation.** Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned; Cārvāka admits a single standpoint. Jaina karma is **subtle matter** adhering to the *jīva* (*bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*), with *mokṣa* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*; Cārvāka rejects karma and holds *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment on the stated criterion.** Jainism offers an **analysis**: the substance–mode distinction explains *why* the same thing can be both persistent and changing, and the standpoint theory explains why one-sided descriptions seem contradictory. Cārvāka offers a **juxtaposition**: eternal elements, transient combinations, and no account of what makes a combination the **same** combination through change — which is precisely why his account of personal identity through memory is thin, resting on bodily continuity without an analysis of what continuity consists in.

ANALYSIS: **The counterweight.** Cārvāka's economy is a genuine virtue. Jainism purchases its explanatory power with six substances, two media of motion and rest, material karma and a sevenfold predication — every one of which is established inferentially, and therefore every one of which the Cārvāka may refuse at the door.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** On the criterion of **accounting for change and persistence**, Jainism is decisively superior; on the criterion of **ontological economy**, Cārvāka is. Since the question specifies the first criterion, the verdict goes to Jainism — but the price is the very inference Cārvāka denies. ANALYSIS: Their shared *nāstika*, realist and non-theistic ground shows how little that classification settles.

Why this earns marks — top-answer checklist

- At least seven named axes, each carrying both positions.
- *Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya* and the *guṇa / paryāya* distinction stated precisely.
- Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* correctly glossed as media of motion and rest.
- The analysis-versus-juxtaposition contrast used as the assessment's pivot.
- The economy counterweight given fairly before the verdict.
- The shared ground noted, and the verdict tied to the **specified** criterion.

Part V — Philosophy Optional High-Score Answer Protocol (Cārvāka)

1. Open with the derivation, not with a definition

Weak : Carvaka is the materialist school of Indian philosophy.

Strong: Carvaka is the position obtained when a single epistemic restriction -- only what perception presents may be admitted -- is applied without exception; its ontology is that epistemology's shadow.

Term	The definition must distinguish it from
<i>Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda</i>	The weaker claim that perception is merely the <i>primary</i> source
<i>Vyāpti</i>	A mere observed regularity
<i>Upādhi</i>	Incomplete enumeration
<i>Dehātmavāda</i>	Buddhist <i>anātman</i> , and eliminativism about consciousness
<i>Svabhāvavāda</i>	Modern scientific naturalism, and <i>adṛṣṭa</i>
<i>Nāstika</i>	"Atheist" in the modern vernacular sense
<i>Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	A recommendation of death

2. Reconstruct the anti-inference argument as premises

1. Inference claims certainty only if licensed by vyapti.
2. Vyapti cannot be known by perception (all cases never surveyed; class-characters equally unsurveyed).
3. Vyapti cannot be known by inference (petitio principii / regress).
4. Vyapti cannot be known by testimony (its validity is inferred; and otherwise no one could infer by himself).
5. Even observed constancy may conceal an upadhi, and hidden conditions cannot be excluded by perception.
6. Therefore truth is accidental and separable in inference.
7. Therefore anumana is not a pramana.

Then expose the **presupposition** — that *pramāṇa*-hood requires indubitability — and note that it is precisely what Nyāya refuses.

3. Sort every objection by its target

THE PREMISE : is "only perception is a pramana" defensible?
(self-refutation; perceptual error; other minds)
THE BRIDGE : must ontology track epistemology?
(the presupposition that reality does not exceed knowledge)
THE AFFIRMATIONS : do four elements and emergence do their explanatory work?
(the explanatory gap; instrument vs cause)
THE CONSEQUENCES : can ethics survive without karma and moksa?
(prudence vs morality; the pleasure of the pig)

Announcing the target in one clause — "this objection attacks the bridge, not the premise" — signals control and saves words.

4. Use Sanskrit as an instrument, not as decoration

- Gloss on first use: *vyāpti* (invariable concomitance), *upādhi* (vitiating condition).
- Preserve epistemic distinctions: *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *śabda*, *upamāna*, *arthāpatti*, *anupalabdhi*.
- Preserve the two directions of the *upādhi* example: **fire** -> **smoke**, defeated by **wet fuel**.
- Preserve the transmitted formulae: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ*, *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

5. Never conflate these six pairs

VALIDITY	vs	GROUNDING OF THE PREMISE	(Socrates syllogism)
PRAMANA-STATUS	vs	PRACTICAL USABILITY	(2019 consistency)
UNESTABLISHED	vs	UNREAL	(transmigration)
DEPENDENCE	vs	PRODUCTION	(consciousness)
RELOCATION	vs	DISSOLUTION of the self	(2024 comparison)
DOXOGRAPHY	vs	PRIMARY TEXT	(every quotation)

6. Present objection and reply dialectically

OBJECTION -> BEST AVAILABLE REPLY -> RESIDUAL PRESSURE

Objection : The denial of inference is itself inferential.
Reply : Soften the thesis -- inference never yields apodictic certainty beyond perceptual check.
Residual : The softened thesis is fallibilism, not a denial of a pramana; the doctrine survives by shrinking.

Steelman the critic before evaluating. Never introduce a weak objection merely to dismiss it.

7. Grade the verdict and name the criterion

Avoid "completely refuted", "totally illogical", "merely hedonistic". Prefer:

- "valid in form but epistemically empty",
- "consistent in derivation, vulnerable in premise",
- "wins on entailment, loses on *pramāṇa*-status",
- "a complete theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality",
- "critical in function, unsuccessful as a system".

Name the criterion: **evidential economy** · **explanatory adequacy** · **internal consistency** · **perceptual redeemability** · **moral sufficiency** · **historiographical reliability**.

8. Marks-wise architecture

Marks	Working time	Architecture
10	7–8 min	Thesis -> three doors -> one sharp addition -> verdict linking epistemology to the denial asked about
15	12–13 min	Frame with source caution -> full argument -> the rival's positive case -> best reply and its cost -> graded verdict
20	17–18 min	Classify -> theory of knowledge in full -> ontological consequences -> the demanded comparison on named axes -> two objections with replies -> criterion-named verdict

- **10 marks ≈ 150 words**. One controlled argument is enough; do not spend half the answer on background.

- **15 marks ≈ 220–260 words.** At least one technical distinction and one serious criticism with a reply.
- **20 marks ≈ 320–360 words.** A comparison matrix may precede the prose; two objections, or one developed through reply and residual pressure.

9. Avoid generic prose

Do not write:

"Cārvāka was a materialist who believed in enjoying life and rejected religion."

Write:

"Cārvāka rejects *dharma* not from appetite but from epistemology: virtue and vice are, in the sources' own words, 'distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted' — so the ethics is the last term in a derivation that begins with the refusal of *śabda* as a *pramāṇa*."

10. Final twenty-second audit

- Did I answer the **directive** — explain, examine, differentiate, critically evaluate, discuss?
- Did I show the **derivation** from epistemology, rather than listing denials?
- Did I reconstruct at least one argument as numbered premises?
- Did I include one **source-caution** clause?
- Did I give the objection **and** the reply before evaluating?
- Did I state a **graded verdict with a named criterion**?
- Did I avoid the two fatal errors — "five elements", and "Cārvāka and Buddhism deny the self in the same way"?